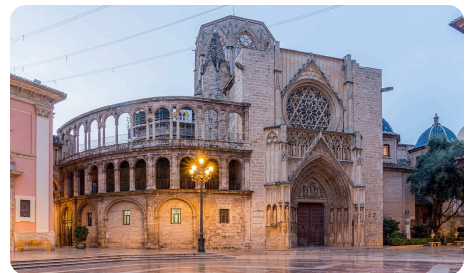




🍅 DAY 08 · Wednesday, Aug 26, 2026 · LA TOMATINA (BUÑOL) + VALENCIA

Prepared for Divyansh · Pure-Vegetarian Edition · Europe 2026



Divyansh · Solo · PURE VEGETARIAN · WanderOn group day _The world's biggest tomato fight — and the reason this whole trip was built around late August._

★ **THE HIGHLIGHT OF THE ENTIRE TRIP.** ~20,000 people, ~120 tonnes of overripe tomatoes, one glorious hour of chaos in a tiny Valencian town. The **_Zindagi Na Milegi Dobara_ finale was filmed right here in Buñol** — you are literally walking into that scene. Everything today bends around protecting this one hour.

🕒 WAKE / LEAVE

- **Wake ~07:00** — non-negotiable. Buñol is a small town swallowed by 20,000 people; roads and bus staging fill fast. Be at the lobby **ready and dressed for the fight** before WanderOn's departure.

- **Eat a real hotel breakfast ~07:00–07:30** — this is your main fuel. There is **no reliable veg food in the Buñol mob**. Load up: bread, fruit, cheese, coffee, water.
- **Bus Valencia → Buñol ≈ 40 min** (~38 km west).

WHAT TO WEAR / BRING (lay it out the NIGHT BEFORE)

THE THREE CRITICAL ITEMS — do not go without these:

1. **Old CLOSED shoes you will THROW AWAY.** Not sandals, not flip-flops — the streets become an ankle-deep slurry of crushed tomato and you can get stepped on / lose footing. Closed-toe = protection. They'll be destroyed; bin them right after.
2. **Swim goggles.**  Tomato juice is **acidic and genuinely stings the eyes**. Goggles are the single biggest comfort upgrade — they let you keep your eyes open and actually *enjoy* the fight.
3. **Waterproof phone pouch** (sealed, lanyard around neck). If you want ANY photos/video, this is the only way the phone survives. Assume everything gets soaked and pulped. **Better still: leave the phone on the bus/hotel and just live it.**

Also wear/bring:

- **Old T-shirt + old shorts you don't care about** (white shirt = classic look, but it WILL be stained red/orange permanently).
- **A fully sealed dry bag or ziplock** for anything that must stay dry (hotel key card, a little cash) — or better, **leave valuables locked at the hotel / on the coach.**
- **Minimal on your person.** No jewelry, no watch, no loose items — pockets get emptied by the chaos.
- **Sunscreen** before you leave (you're outdoors from ~09:00). Optional: small water bottle, cheap plastic poncho (most people skip it).

HOUR-BY-HOUR

Time	What happens	Notes
~07:00	Wake, big hotel breakfast , final pack	Wear the throwaway clothes + closed shoes. Goggles + phone pouch on you.
~07:30–08:00	WanderOn coach departs Valencia → Buñol (~40 min)	Sit with the group. Keep your wristband ON.

Time	What happens	Notes
~08:15–08:45	Arrive Buñol, walk in with the group	Streets already filling. Note the meetup point + bus location for later.
~09:00–10:45	 The _palo jabón_ (greased pole)	A tall pole smeared with soap/grease, a ham tied at the top . Crowds build a human pyramid to knock it down. Traditionally the fight doesn't start until the ham drops. As a veg, just enjoy the spectacle — no need to climb. Soak up the energy, hydrate.
11:00	 THE FIGHT BEGINS — signal cannon/rocket fires	Trucks dump ~120 tonnes of overripe tomatoes into the streets.
11:00–12:00	   THE FIGHT (~1 hour)	Everyone vs everyone. Grab, squash, throw, get pulped, laugh. This is the moment. (Rules below.)
~12:00	 Second cannon = FIGHT OVER	The end signal. Stop throwing immediately.
~12:00–13:00	 Hose-down	Locals hose everyone off from balconies and fire hoses — the town power-washes you and the streets. Rinse your goggles + phone pouch here too.
Afternoon	 Coach back to Valencia , clean up at hotel	Long, proper shower — tomato gets EVERYWHERE (ears, hair, waistband). Bin the shoes + ruined clothes.
Evening	 REST + easy Valencia veg dinner	⚠️ Physically wrecking day. Plan nothing ambitious tonight. Early night — tomorrow is travel to Madrid.

THE RULES OF THE FIGHT (official — follow them)

- ⚠️ **SQUASH / CRUSH tomatoes before throwing** — throw them soft, never as a hard whole projectile. The #1 safety rule.
- Only tomatoes** — no bottles, no hard objects.
- Do NOT rip anyone's clothes.**
- Stop the moment the second cannon fires.**
- Make way for the tomato trucks** — don't get pinned under them.

Play it smart: position **mid-crowd, not dead-center under the trucks** — plenty of action without the crush. **Keep goggles ON the whole hour.** Don't over-film — a couple of bursts, then put the phone away and actually be in it. Stay loosely near the WanderOn group / know the rally point (phones dead + soaked in a 20,000-person mob).

TRANSPORT

- **Valencia → Buñol → Valencia:** the **WanderOn coach**. ~40 min each way. ✅ **Cost INCLUDED** — no train/taxi to arrange.
- Keep track of where the coach is parked in Buñol for the ride back.

VEGETARIAN FOOD

Veg phrase: _"Soy vegetariano estricto, sin carne ni pescado ni marisco."_ Use **HappyCow** if you want a certain spot.

- **Breakfast: eat BIG at the hotel** — this is your real fuel; there's no good veg option in the Buñol crush.
- **Buñol day:** don't count on food in town — carry a little water; snack on the coach if WanderOn provides.
- **Valencia dinner (easy, near hotel):** Valencia is the **home of paella** — order ★ _**paella de verduras**_ (**vegetable paella**) and confirm the **veg-only** version: _"sin carne, sin pescado, sin marisco, sin caldo de carne — con caldo vegetal"_ (many paella bases use meat/fish stock — ask for veg stock). Other safe bets: **patatas bravas**, **pan con tomate**, **Spanish tortilla** (potato omelette — confirm no meat), **grilled veg**, **agua de Valencia** (the local drink), **horchata + fartons**.

TICKETS

Item	Status
La Tomatina wristband + transport	✅ INCLUDED (WanderOn) — nothing to buy
Valencia coach (round trip)	✅ INCLUDED (WanderOn)

- **The wristband is your entry** into the roped official fight zone. Put it on when the guide hands it out and **do NOT take it off / do NOT lose it** — no wristband, no entry.

TIPS

- ⚠️ **Bring the three: old closed shoes (throwaway), swim goggles, waterproof phone pouch.** (Repeated because it's the whole game.)
- **Hydrate** hard before and after — you'll strain for hours in late-August Spanish heat.
- **Sunscreen** before leaving (outdoors from ~09:00).

- **Expect stinging** if tomato acid gets in cuts/eyes — goggles handle the eyes; rinse cuts at the hose-down.
 - **Leave valuables at the hotel or locked on the coach.** Carry only what can be destroyed.
 - **This day WILL wipe you out.** Plan zero for the evening beyond shower, food, sleep.
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Movies, Songs & Pop Culture Here (Bollywood + Hollywood)

BUÑOL / LA TOMATINA — THE BIG ONE (a bucket-list Bollywood pilgrimage):

- **_Zindagi Na Milegi Dobara_ (2011)** filmed its **iconic La Tomatina climax right here in Buñol**. Hrithik Roshan, Farhan Akhtar, Abhay Deol (and Katrina Kaif) run into the tomato-fight finale — the euphoric, paint-it-red ending of the film that made an entire generation of Indians add La Tomatina to their bucket list.
- The scene plays out to **_"Ik Junoon (Paint It Red)"_** — the anthem of the fight. Hum it while you're in it.
-  **Say it out loud: you are literally standing inside that scene.** This is the Bollywood pilgrimage moment of the whole trip — the tomatoes flying around you are the exact chaos on screen. Have that in your head at 11:00 when the cannon fires.  

VALENCIA (back tonight):

- **_Tomorrowland_ (2015, Disney · George Clooney)** filmed at Valencia's **City of Arts & Sciences** — the futuristic white Calatrava complex (Hemisfèric, Science Museum, Oceanogràfic) that plays the movie's utopian "city of the future."
 - The same complex also appears in **_Doctor Who_** and **_Westworld_** — Hollywood's favorite stand-in for "the future."
 -  **Exact spot:** along the old Turia riverbed, ~15 min from the center. Too wrecked tonight — but it's the photo stop if you get a free hour tomorrow morning before Madrid.
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ONE-LINE SUMMARY

Wake ~7 AM → big veg breakfast → WanderOn coach to Buñol (~40 min) → greased-pole spectacle → **11:00 the one-hour, 120-tonne tomato war** (goggles on, squash before throwing, throwaway closed shoes, phone pouched) → ~12:00 water-cannon end + hose-down → coach back → long shower → rest + light **paella de verduras** dinner. The trip's emotional peak — and utterly exhausting.  

 *Film-location thread runs through the trip · full repo: github.com/divyanshh/trip*